

LAUREN HOMANN

Curriculum Vitae

University of Toronto, Department of Psychology
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EDUCATION

Doctor of Philosophy in Psychology
University of Toronto, Toronto, Canada

Expected: 2027

Supervisor: Dr. Morgan Barense

Committee: Drs. Katherine Duncan & Meg Schlichting

Honours Bachelor of Science in Psychology, Biology Minor
University of Waterloo, Waterloo, Canada

2022

Advisors: Dr. Daniel Smilek and Allison Drody

Honours Thesis Title: “The effects of self-selected background music and task difficulty on task engagement and performance in a visual vigilance task”

Graduated with Dean’s Honours

PUBLICATIONS (2 peer-reviewed articles; 1 preprint; all as first author)

Supervised students/research assistants are underlined | * Denotes shared first authorship

1. **Homann, L. A.**, Drody, A. C., Smilek, D. (2023). The effects of self-selected music and task difficulty on task engagement and performance in a visual vigilance task. *Psychological Research*, 87, 2460–2476. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s00426-023-01836-6>
2. **Homann, L. A.***, Roberts, B. R. T.*, Ahmed, S., Fernandes, M. A. (2022). Are emojis processed visuo-spatially or verbally? Evidence for dual codes. *Visual Cognition*, 30(4), 267–279. <https://doi.org/10.1080/13506285.2022.2050871>

PREPRINTS

3. **Homann, L. A.**, Jahed, M., Barense, M. D. (2025). Putting the testing effect to the test in the wild: Retrieval enhances real-world memories and promotes their semantic integration while preserving episodic integrity. *PsyArXiv*. https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/923rj_v2

TALKS (8 presentations; 6 as first author)

Supervised students/research assistants are underlined | * Denotes shared first authorship | (v) Denotes a virtual presentation

1. **Homann, L. A.**, Barense, M. D. “Retrieval Practice Drives Integration Across Related Memories: A Candidate Mechanism for the Testing Effect”. Ebbinghaus Empire Talk Series (Data Blitz), Nov. 2025 (Toronto, ON, Canada)
2. **Homann, L. A.**, Barense, M. D. “Neural Mechanisms of Retrieval Practice-Induced Integration”. Toronto Neuroimaging Facility (ToNI) Users Meeting, Oct. 2025 (Toronto, ON, Canada)

3. Barense, M. D., **Homann, L. A.** “Putting the Testing Effect to the Test in the Wild: Retrieval Enhances Real-World Memories and Promotes their Semantic Integration While Preserving Episodic Integrity”. Memory Disorders Research Society Annual Meeting, Oct. 2025 (Montreal, QC, Canada)
4. **Homann, L. A.**, Barense, M. D. “Testing the testing effect for real-world memories”. Toronto Area Memory Group (TAMeG) Annual Meeting, May 2025 (Toronto, ON, Canada)
5. **Homann, L. A.**, Jahed, M., Sun, J., Gu, J., Grewal, S., Barense, M. D. “When practice doesn’t make perfect: Retrieving real-word memories strengthens reviewed content and semantic links without broader episodic changes”. Ebbinghaus Empire Talk Series (Data Blitz), Dec. 2024 (Toronto, ON, Canada)
6. Sacchi, S., Sisson, N., Chan, J., Hong, B., **Homann, L. A.**, Doyle, L., Galarneau, E., Vijayarajah, S., Yang, C., Yim, A., Page-Gould, E. “Building endurance to SPRINT: A longitudinal assessment of high school student outcomes after participating in a summer psychology outreach program”. Society for the Teaching of Psychology’s (STP’s) Annual Conference on Teaching, Oct. 2024 (Louisville, KY, USA)
7. **Homann, L. A.**, Drody, A. C., Smilek, D. “The effects of self-selected music and task difficulty on task engagement and performance in a visual vigilance task”. Seminar in Attention and Multi-Tasking (taught by Dr. Nathan Ward) at Tufts University, Oct. 2023 (v)
8. **Homann, L. A.**, Drody, A. C., Smilek, D. “The effects of self-selected music and task difficulty on task engagement and performance in a visual vigilance task”. Laboratory for Attention and Social Cognition at McGill University, Jan. 2022 (v)

POSTERS (8 poster presentations; 7 as first author)

Supervised students/research assistants are underlined | * Denotes shared first authorship | (v) Denotes a virtual presentation

1. **Homann, L. A.**, Golestani, A., Bouffard, N. R., Moscovitch, M., Barense, M. D. “Novel dynamic autocorrelation measure (dAC) uncovers time-dependent changes in the organization of neural timescales along the hippocampal long axis”. BrainModes International Meeting, Oct. 2025 (Toronto, ON, Canada)
2. Golestani, A., **Homann, L. A.**, Bouffard, N. R., Moscovitch, M., Barense, M. D. “Dynamic autocorrelation as a tool to measure time-dependent changes in neuronal time-scale along the hippocampus axis during resting-state.” International Society for Magnetic Resonance in Medicine Annual Meeting, May. 2025 (Honolulu, HI, USA)
3. **Homann, L. A.**, Jahed, M., Sun, J., Gu, J., Grewal, S., Barense, M. D. “When practice doesn’t make perfect: Retrieving real-word memories strengthens reviewed content and semantic links without broader episodic changes”. Cognitive Neuroscience Society (CNS) Annual Meeting, Mar. 2025 (Boston, MA, USA)
4. Jahed, M.*, **Homann, L. A.***, Barense, M. D. “The influence of retrieval practice on real-life event memory”. Lake Ontario Visionary Establishment (LOVE) Conference, Feb. 2025 (Niagara Falls, ON, Canada)
5. **Homann, L. A.**, Golestani, A., Bouffard, N. R., Moscovitch, M., Barense, M. D. “Novel dynamic autocorrelation measure (dAC) uncovers time-dependent changes in the organization of neural timescales along the hippocampal long axis”. Society for Neuroscience (SfN) Annual Meeting, Oct. 2024 (Chicago, IL, USA)

6. **Homann, L. A., Sun, J., An, J.,** Barensen, M. D. “The influence of retrieval practice on real-life event memory”. Cognitive Neuroscience Society (CNS) Annual Meeting, Apr. 2024 (Toronto, ON, Canada)
7. **Homann, L. A., Sun, J., An, J.,** Barensen, M. D. “The influence of retrieval practice on real-life event memory”. Lake Ontario Visionary Establishment (LOVE) Conference, Feb. 2024 (Niagara Falls, ON, Canada)
8. **Homann, L. A.,*** Roberts, B. R. T. *, Ahmed, S., Fernandes, M. A. “Are emojis processed visuo-spatially or verbally? Evidence for dual codes”. Psychonomic Society Annual Meeting, Nov. 2021 (v)

PUBLIC WRITING

1. **Homann, L. A.,** (2025, April 21). Moving beyond traditional pathways in cognitive neuroscience. *Cognitive Neuroscience Society 2025 Blog*.
<https://www.cogneurosociety.org/moving-beyond-traditional-pathways-in-cognitive-neuroscience/>

FELLOWSHIPS AND GRANTS

Canada Graduate Scholarship—Doctoral Natural Sciences and Engineering Research Council of Canada	\$115,000	2023–2026
Conference Grant School of Graduate Studies, University of Toronto	\$620	2025
Conference Travel Award Department of Psychology, University of Toronto	\$500	2024
Canada Graduate Scholarship—Masters Natural Sciences and Engineering Research Council of Canada	\$17,500	2022–2023
Undergraduate Student Research Award Natural Sciences and Engineering Research Council of Canada	\$4,500	2020

HONOURS AND AWARDS

Award of Academic Excellence Canadian Psychological Association		2022
Recruitment Award University of Toronto, Department of Psychology	\$5,000	2022
Honours Thesis Award University of Waterloo, Department of Psychology		2022
Term Distinction University of Waterloo		2020–2022
University of Toronto Scholars Award University of Toronto	\$6,000	2016

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Ph.D. Student Memory and Perception Lab, University of Toronto <i>Principal Investigator:</i> Dr. Morgan Barense	Sep. 2022–present
Honours Thesis Student and Research Assistant Vision and Attention Lab, University of Waterloo <i>Principal Investigator:</i> Dr. Daniel Smilek	Jan. 2021–Aug. 2022
Research Assistant Cognitive Neuroscience Lab, University of Waterloo <i>Principal Investigator:</i> Dr. Myra Fernandes	Jan. 2020–May 2022
Research Assistant Psychological Interventions Research Team, University of Waterloo <i>Principal Investigator:</i> Dr. Jonathan Oakman	May 2019–Aug. 2020

STUDENTS SUPERVISED

▪ David Choi, <i>Volunteer</i>	Nov. 2025–present
▪ Harshita Mishra, <i>Volunteer</i>	Nov. 2025–present
▪ Jia Gu, <i>Volunteer</i> (Current position: PhD student in cognitive psychology at University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign)	Mar. 2024–Nov. 2024
▪ Simran Grewal, <i>Volunteer</i>	Mar. 2024–Nov. 2024
▪ Mursal Jahed, <i>Individual Project</i> (Current position: MA student in clinical neuropsychology at Toronto Metropolitan University)	Jan. 2023–Apr. 2025
▪ Amir Samadi, <i>Individual Project</i>	Jan. 2024–Apr. 2024
▪ Janice An, <i>Research Opportunity Program</i>	Sep. 2023–Apr. 2024
▪ Jessica Sun, <i>Research Opportunity Program and Individual Project</i> (Current position: Doctor of optometry student at University of California, Berkeley)	May 2023–Nov. 2023
▪ Shelby Davies, <i>Mini-Thesis</i>	Jan. 2023–Apr. 2023

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming languages and tools: R, JavaScript, Python, Bash, Git, HTML, FSL, AFNI

Data analysis programs: SPSS, jamovi, NVivo, Taguette, Excel, JASP

Experiment programming: JSPsych, PsychoPy, E-Prime, OpenSesame, Qualtrics, JATOS
Experiment Manager, cognition.run

Apparatus: EyeLink eye-tracking system

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Co-Lecturer for High School Workshop Series

Apr. 2024

University of Toronto Faculty of Arts and Science

- Title of Lecture: “Highlights of Experimental Psychology from the Summer Psychology Research Initiative” (co-instructed with Logan Doyle and Catalina Yang)

Guest Instructor for the Summer Psychology Research Initiative (SPRINT)

Jul. 2023

Psychology Equity Diversity and Inclusion Committee, University of Toronto

- Title of Lecture: “The Testing Effect: Applications to Real-World Event Memory”

Research Advisor for the Summer Psychology Research Initiative (SPRINT)

Jul. 2023

Psychology Equity Diversity and Inclusion Committee, University of Toronto

- Taught high school students foundational research methods and advised them in developing a university-level written research proposal and accompanying presentation

Direct Supervisor for Undergraduate Independent Research Course (ROP299/399 and PSY309/405/406)

Jan. 2023–Apr. 2025

Department of Psychology, University of Toronto

- Taught undergraduate students research methods, scientific writing, oral presentation skills, and how to design and present academic posters

Teaching Assistant

Department of Psychology, University of Toronto

- PSY201: Statistics I

Fall 2022, Fall 2023,
Fall 2024, Fall 2025

MENTORSHIP AND SERVICE

Ad Hoc Reviewer

Journal of Cognitive Neuroscience, Learning and Memory, Canadian Journal of Experimental Psychology

President

Jul. 2024–present

Cognitive Neuroscience Society Trainee Association (CNSTA), Cognitive Neuroscience Society (CNS)

- Represent the trainee (graduate student and postdoctoral fellow) affiliates of the Cognitive Neuroscience Society (CNS) and serve in an advisory capacity to the CNS Executive Committee
- Plan and moderate the annual professional development panel and trainee social

Chair of the Program Committee

Sep. 2024–Jun. 2025

Toronto Area Memory Group (TAMeG)

- Led a committee that recruited and organized the panel, organized the talks, and made the schedule for an annual conference for memory researchers in southern Ontario

Executive Member

Sep. 2023–Sep. 2024

Summer Psychology Research Initiative (SPRINT), Psychology Equity Diversity and Inclusion Committee, University of Toronto

- Planned SPRINT, an outreach program aimed to support high school students underrepresented in higher education in learning about psychology and gaining research experience

Orientation Coordinator

Sep. 2023–Sep. 2024

Psychology Graduate Students Association, University of Toronto

- Organized and executed events during recruitment and orientation weeks for incoming graduate students

Conference Co-organizer

Sep. 2023–May 2024

Toronto Area Memory Group (TAMeG)

- Coordinated and planned an annual conference for memory researchers in southern Ontario

Graduate Mentor

Jul. 2023

Summer Psychology Research Initiative (SPRINT), Psychology Equity Diversity and Inclusion Committee, University of Toronto

- Mentored a group of six high school students and advised them on creating a university-level research proposal and presentation

Committee Lead

Jan. 2023–May 2023

Workshop/Keynote Committee, Psychology Graduate Students Association, University of Toronto

- Led a committee that planned the keynote and workshop components of the annual symposium
- Created, organized, and moderated a panel on academic publishing

Graduate Mentor

Sep. 2022–Mar. 2023

Psychology Equity Diversity and Inclusion Committee, University of Toronto

- Advised undergraduate students applying to research-based graduate programs and research assistant positions, provided feedback on application materials, and aided in facilitating CV and personal statement workshops

Peer Mentor

Sep. 2021–Apr. 2022

Department of Psychology, University of Waterloo

- Mentored seven undergraduate psychology students

President

Jan. 2020–Aug. 2021

Undergraduate Psychology Society (PsychSoc), University of Waterloo

- Oversaw day-to-day functioning of PsychSoc, its executive members, and the tuck shop

Vice President of Events

Sep. 2019–Dec. 2020

Undergraduate Psychology Society (PsychSoc), University of Waterloo

- Led a group of volunteers in the planning of academic and social events for undergraduate psychology students